

Table 2: Workforce Characteristics, Guards, 2001-2025

Contractor = Outsourced; In-House = Directly Employed

	2001-2005		2006-2010		2011-2015		2016-2019		2021-2025	
	In-house	Contractor	In-house	Contractor	In-house	Contractor	In-house	Contractor	In-house	Contractor
Employment and wages										
Mean hourly wage (2025\$)	\$22.36	\$19.24	\$22.83	\$19.06	\$23.16	\$18.42	\$23.75	\$19.81	\$23.61	\$21.05
Unionization rate	17.5%	8.3%	15.3%	9.1%	17.7%	8.5%	19.4%	10.9%	17.8%	8.6%
Part-time rate	14.0%	10.9%	13.3%	11.0%	13.9%	12.7%	12.8%	10.8%	12.7%	13.5%
Government employee	32.8%	3.3%	32.7%	2.9%	34.4%	2.2%	35.1%	2.4%	32.4%	2.6%
Demographics										
Mean age	41.4	41.3	42.0	41.3	42.4	41.3	42.4	40.8	43.2	41.0
Female	24.0%	23.0%	22.9%	22.5%	21.8%	20.7%	22.7%	23.3%	26.2%	25.7%
Black	24.3%	32.7%	23.5%	33.7%	22.7%	31.9%	24.6%	34.8%	25.5%	40.1%
Hispanic	13.4%	12.1%	13.2%	15.0%	16.9%	17.4%	17.6%	17.3%	19.2%	18.7%
Education										
Less than high school	9.3%	12.6%	5.0%	8.9%	4.7%	7.0%	3.4%	5.8%	3.7%	5.1%
High school / GED	38.6%	44.9%	35.0%	45.0%	33.2%	39.9%	31.0%	38.0%	35.6%	45.0%
Some college	36.0%	32.3%	41.1%	36.0%	40.7%	39.7%	42.1%	42.4%	38.6%	34.9%
Bachelor's or higher	16.1%	10.3%	18.8%	10.0%	21.3%	13.4%	23.5%	13.8%	22.1%	15.0%
Sample										
Unweighted N (regression sample)	2,911	2,515	2,964	2,569	2,937	2,479	2,236	1,837	1,931	1,767
Workers represented (thousands)	417	387	467	429	483	440	509	459	460	476

Data: CPS-ORG via IPUMS. Years: 2001-2025, 2020 excluded. Part-time = usual hours under 30. Weights: EARNWT. Statistics use the author's regression sample (non-missing log_wage and every model covariate); N = observations with non-missing wages and all model covariates. Workers represented is average monthly employment estimated from EARNWT on all sampled base-sample workers, including those excluded for missing wages or covariates: sum(EARNWT) divided by the number of distinct survey months (ym) for that occupation in the period, in thousands, rounded to the nearest thousand. FE: state x year and clustering by survey month (ym) apply to regression tables only; Tables 1-2 are descriptive. Stars: * p<.10, ** p<.05, *** p<.01, two-tailed.